

Word family: **admire / admires / admired / admiring / admiration / admirable / admirably**

Base word: admire

Third-person singular: admires

Past tense: admired

Past participle: admired

** -ing form:** admiring

Related forms: admiration, admirable, admirably, admiring

Useful constructions/extensions: admire someone, admire someone for something, admire the way someone does something, admire a view, admire a painting, admiration for, admirable quality, admiring glance

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / related noun, adjective, and adverb forms (相關名詞、形容詞及副詞)

Your passage contains:

> “I also **admire the way she has handled hardship in life** without becoming bitter.”

Here, **admire** means:

to respect someone greatly because you value their character, behaviour, strength, or achievements.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **admire the way she has handled hardship**

you respect your grandmother because:

* she has faced difficult experiences;

* she has remained kind;

* she has not become bitter;

* she has shown emotional strength.

So **admire** is not simply:

> like

and it is not just:

> think something is beautiful.

It expresses:

> ****respect + approval + appreciation****

for a quality or way of behaving.

****Meaning:**** To respect and approve of someone because of their qualities, actions, or achievements.

****繁體中文:**** ****敬佩；欣賞某人的品格、行為或成就，並因此對他 / 她有高度尊重****

****中文翻譯:****

> “I also admire the way she has handled hardship in life without becoming bitter.”

「我也很****敬佩****她面對人生困境時的方式，因為她沒有因此變得憤世嫉俗。」

So:

****admire someone/the way someone does something = 敬佩某人 / 欣賞某人的處事方式****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****admire = respect someone for their qualities/actions (敬佩) — 欣賞；敬佩****

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** To have a high opinion of someone because of their character, actions, achievements, or abilities.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I ****admire the way she has handled hardship**** in life.”

「我很****敬佩她面對人生困境的方式****。」

Practice 2

> “I really ****admire her patience****.”

「我真的很****欣賞 / 敬佩她的耐性****。」

Practice 3

> “He is widely ****admired for his honesty****.”

「他因誠實而****廣受敬佩****。」

****admire** = 因某人的品格、能力、行為或成就而尊重 / 欣賞對方******

2. ****admire someone for something** (因某事敬佩某人) — 因.....而欣賞 / 敬佩******

A major construction.

Practice 4

> “I ****admire her for staying calm**** under pressure.”

「我很****敬佩她在壓力下仍能保持冷靜****。」

Practice 5

> “People admire him for his courage.”

「人們因他的勇氣而****敬佩他****。」

****admire someone for X** = 因某項特質、行為或成就而對某人產生高度尊重******

3. ****admire the way someone does something** (欣賞某人的處事方式) — 敬佩；欣賞******

This is very close to your passage.

Practice 6

> “I ****admire the way she treats people****.”

「我很****欣賞她待人的方式****。」

Practice 7

> “We admired the way he handled the situation.”

「我們很****敬佩他處理那件事的方式****。」

****admire the way someone...** = 對某人的做法、態度或處事方式表示尊重與肯定******

4. **admire = value someone's achievement/ability (佩服能力 / 成就) — 欣賞 ; 佩服**

Practice 8

> “I have always **admired her ability to stay focused**.”

「我一直很**佩服她保持專注的能力**。」

Practice 9

> “Many young players admire her skill.”

「很多年輕運動員都**佩服她的技術**。」

admire = 對能力、技巧或成就抱有高度肯定與尊重

5. **admire = look at something with pleasure (欣賞觀看) — 欣賞 ; 觀賞**

A major separate meaning.

****Meaning:**** To look at something and enjoy or appreciate its beauty, appearance, or quality.

Practice 10

> “We stopped to **admire the view**.”

「我們停下來**欣賞風景**。」

Practice 11

> “She stood there **admiring the painting**.”

「她站在那裡**欣賞那幅畫**。」

admire = 看著某物並因其美感、外觀或品質而感到愉悅 / 欣賞

This is genuinely different from respecting a person's character.

6. **admire the view/scenery (欣賞風景) — 欣賞 ; 觀賞**

Practice 12

> “They sat quietly and **admired the scenery**.”

「他們安靜地坐著**欣賞風景**。」

Practice 13

> “We climbed the hill to admire the view.”

「我們爬上山去**欣賞景色**。」

admire scenery/view = 因景色漂亮 / 壯觀而欣賞觀看

7. **admire an object/artwork (欣賞物件 / 藝術品) — 欣賞**

Practice 14

> “Visitors stopped to **admire the sculpture**.”

「遊客停下來**欣賞雕塑**。」

Practice 15

> “She admired the craftsmanship of the table.”

「她很**欣賞那張桌子的工藝**。」

admire = 對物件的設計、美感、技巧或製作質素表示欣賞

8. **admire yourself (欣賞自己 / 照鏡自賞) — 自我欣賞**

A more specific use.

Practice 16

> “He stood in front of the mirror **admiring himself**.”

「他站在鏡子前**欣賞自己的樣子**。」

Practice 17

> “She admired herself in the new dress.”

「她穿著新裙子，對著鏡子**欣賞自己**。」

admire yourself = 看著自己的外貌並感到滿意 / 欣賞

Depending on tone, it can sound playful or slightly self-satisfied.

9. **admiration (敬佩 / 欣賞) — 敬意 ; 欣賞**

A major related noun.

Practice 18

> “I have great **admiration for** my grandmother.”

「我對外婆有很深的**敬佩**。」

Practice 19

> “Her courage earned everyone’s admiration.”

「她的勇氣贏得了大家的**敬佩**。」

admiration = 因某人的品格、能力、成就或某物的美感而產生的高度欣賞 / 敬意

10. **admiration for someone/something (對.....的敬佩 / 欣賞) — 敬意 ; 欣賞**

Practice 20

> “She spoke with great **admiration for her teacher**.”

「她談到老師時充滿**敬意**。」

Practice 21

> “His admiration for the artist was obvious.”

「他對那位藝術家的**欣賞 / 敬佩**很明顯。」

admiration for X = 對某人 / 某事抱有高度欣賞或尊重

11. **admirable (值得敬佩的) — 可敬的 ; 值得欣賞的**

A major adjective.

Practice 22

> “Her patience is **admirable**.”

「她的耐性**很值得敬佩**。」

Practice 23

> “He showed admirable courage.”

「他展現出**令人敬佩的勇氣**。」

admirable = 某種品格、行為或成就值得別人尊重 / 欣賞

12. **admirable quality/behaviour (值得敬佩的特質 / 行為) — 可敬的**

Practice 24

> “Kindness is an **admirable quality**.”

「善良是一種**值得敬佩的品格**。」

Practice 25

> “Her response was calm and admirable.”

「她的回應很冷靜，也**值得欣賞**。」

admirable = 值得正面評價和尊重的

13. **admirably (令人敬佩地) — 出色地 ; 值得敬佩地**

A useful related adverb.

Practice 26

> “She handled the situation **admirably**.”

「她把事情處理得**非常出色 / 令人敬佩**。」

Practice 27

> “He behaved admirably under pressure.”

「他在壓力下表現得**很值得敬佩**。」

admirably = 以令人尊敬 / 欣賞的方式

14. **admiring** (欣賞 / 讚賞的) — 欣賞的 ; 敬佩的

A major related adjective.

Practice 28

> “She gave him an **admiring look**.”

「她向他投以**欣賞 / 佩服的目光**。」

Practice 29

> “The audience made admiring comments.”

「觀眾發表了很多**讚賞的評論**。」

admiring = 表現出欣賞、敬佩或讚美的態度

15. **admiring glance/look** (欣賞的目光) — 欣賞 / 讚賞的眼神

Practice 30

> “He gave the car an **admiring glance**.”

「他用**欣賞的眼光**看了那輛車一眼。」

Practice 31

> “She looked at her grandmother with an admiring smile.”

「她帶著**敬佩的微笑**看著外婆。」

****admiring = 從表情 / 目光中顯示對某人 / 某物的欣賞****

16. ****much-admired (備受敬佩 / 欣賞的) — 廣受敬佩 ; 備受欣賞****

A common compound-style adjective.

Practice 32

> “She is a ****much-admired**** teacher.”

「她是一位****備受敬佩的老師****。」

Practice 33

> “The building is a much-admired example of modern design.”

「這棟建築是現代設計中****備受欣賞的例子****。」

****much-admired = 受到很多人高度欣賞 / 敬佩的****

17. ****admire = appreciate beauty/skill without personal respect (欣賞美感 / 技巧) — 欣賞****

This distinction is worth making explicit.

Practice 34

> “I ****admire the design****, even though I wouldn’t buy it.”

「我很****欣賞這個設計****，雖然我不會買它。」

Practice 35

> “She admired the precision of his work.”

「她很****欣賞他工作的精準程度****。」

****admire = 對美感、技巧、工藝或品質表示高度欣賞，不一定涉及對人的道德尊重****

Important distinction: **admire vs like**

This is one of the most important contrasts.

like

= feel positive affection/enjoyment.

admire

= respect or appreciate because of qualities, achievements, beauty, or skill.

You can:

> like someone without admiring them

and:

> admire someone without knowing them personally.

In your passage:

> "I like her..."

and:

> "I admire the way she handled hardship..."

express different ideas.

Like = affection

Admire = respect/appreciation

Important distinction: **admire vs respect**

These overlap strongly.

respect

= recognize someone's value, rights, position, qualities, or achievements.

admire

= feel positive respect plus appreciation.

Compare:

> “I respect her professionalism.”

= I recognize and value it.

> “I admire her courage.”

= I actively feel impressed by it.

****Admire**** is often warmer/more appreciative.

Important distinction: **admire vs appreciate**

**admire**

= feel impressed by / respect highly / enjoy beauty.

**appreciate**

= recognize value, quality, effort, significance, or kindness.

> “I admire her courage.”

= 我敬佩她的勇氣。

> “I appreciate her help.”

= 我感激 / 欣賞她的幫助。

****Appreciate**** can include gratitude; ****admire**** normally does not.

Important distinction: **admire vs praise**

**admire**

= internal attitude/feeling.

**praise**

= openly express approval.

You may admire someone without saying anything.

If you praise them, you express it verbally or publicly.

Important distinction: **admire vs look up to**

admire

= respect highly.

look up to

= admire someone as a person/role model.

> "I admire her patience."

> "I look up to my grandmother."

The second more strongly suggests:

> I see her as someone I want to learn from.

Important distinction: **admire vs adore**

admire

= respect/appreciate.

adore

= love very strongly.

> admire a teacher

may involve respect.

> adore a grandmother

expresses strong affection.

Different emotional focus.

Important distinction: **admire vs envy**

These can coexist but are very different.

admire

= positive respect/appreciation.

envy

= wish you had something another person has.

> “I admire her confidence.”

= I respect it.

> “I envy her confidence.”

= I wish I had it.

Important distinction: **admire vs be impressed by**

These overlap.

be impressed by

= react positively to something striking, skillful, or effective.

admire

often suggests deeper, more lasting appreciation/respect.

> “I was impressed by the presentation.”

may be momentary.

> “I admire her professionalism.”

sounds more enduring.

Important distinction: **admire a person vs admire a view**

Same verb, different object relationship.

Person:

> “I admire my grandmother.”

= 敬佩我的外婆。

View:

> “I admire the view.”

= 欣賞風景。

With a person, **admire** often means respect.

With scenery/art/object, it usually means:

> look at with pleasure/appreciation.

Important distinction: **admire someone for X vs admire X**

**admire someone for X**

= respect the person because of a particular quality/action.

> “I admire her for her patience.”

**admire X**

= appreciate/respect the quality itself.

> “I admire her patience.”

Both are natural.

Important distinction: **admire the way vs like the way**

admire the way she handled it

= respect the skill/character shown.

like the way she handled it

= feel positive about the method/result.

Admire is stronger and emphasizes merit.

Important distinction: **admiration vs respect**

admiration

= strong positive appreciation.

respect

= broader recognition of worth/status/boundaries.

You can respect someone without particularly admiring them.

Important distinction: **admirable vs admirable-looking**

admirable

= worthy of respect.

It does **not** normally mean:

> physically attractive.

So:

> “an admirable person”

= 值得敬佩的人

not:

> 好看的人.

Important distinction: **admirable vs impressive**

admirable

= worthy of approval/respect, often morally or personally.

impressive

= causes admiration because of size, skill, quality, effectiveness, etc.

A huge building can be:

> impressive

without being:

> admirable

in a moral sense.

Important distinction: **admirable vs admirable performance**

When applied to performance:

> admirable performance

means:

> a performance deserving approval/respect.

It does not necessarily mean:

> the absolute best performance.

The word is evaluative but not superlative.

Important distinction: **admiring vs admirable**

These are easily confused.

admiring

= showing admiration.

> “an admiring look”

= 欣賞 / 敬佩的目光

admirable

= deserving admiration.

> “admirable courage”

= 值得敬佩的勇氣

So:

admiring = the observer feels admiration

admirable = the target deserves admiration

Important distinction: **admired vs admirable**

admired

= actually receives admiration from people.

> “a widely admired leader”

admirable

= deserves admiration.

A person could be admirable but not widely known enough to be admired by many people.

Important distinction: **admiration vs admiration of beauty**

The noun can cover both major senses:

Respect:

> “admiration for her courage”

= 對她勇氣的敬佩

Appreciation of beauty:

> “admiration for the painting”

= 對畫作的欣賞

Context decides whether Chinese is better as:

> 敬佩

or:

> 欣賞.

Important distinction: **admire yourself**

This can be neutral:

> appreciate how you look.

But depending on tone, it can suggest:

> vanity / self-satisfaction.

So context matters.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **admire** family is compact but has a very important two-way semantic split:

* **admire someone** = 敬佩某人

* **admire someone for X** = 因某事敬佩某人

* **admire a quality** = 欣賞 / 敬佩某種特質

* **admire the way someone does something** = 欣賞 / 敬佩某人的處事方式

* **admire a view/scenery** = 欣賞景色

* **admire artwork/design** = 欣賞藝術 / 設計

* **admire yourself** = 欣賞自己的外表

* **admiration** = 欣賞 / 敬佩

* **admiration for** = 對.....的欣賞 / 敬佩
 * **admirable** = 值得敬佩 / 欣賞的
 * **admirably** = 令人敬佩地 / 出色地
 * **admiring** = 表現出欣賞 / 敬佩的
 * **admiring look/glance** = 欣賞 / 敬佩的目光
 * **much-admired** = 備受敬佩 / 欣賞的

The main semantic branches are:

> **respect someone because of qualities, behaviour, ability, or achievement**

and:

> **look at/appreciate something because it is beautiful, impressive, or skillful**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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admire — respect	因某人的品格、行為、能力或成就而對其抱有高度尊重與欣賞
admire someone for X	因某項特質、行為或成就而敬佩某人
admire the way someone...	對某人的處事方式 / 態度表示尊重與肯定
admire a quality/ability	高度欣賞 / 佩服某種特質或能力
admire — look at with pleasure	因某物漂亮、出色或精巧而欣賞觀看
admire a view/scenery	因景色漂亮 / 壯觀而欣賞觀看
admire artwork/design	對藝術、設計、工藝或外觀品質表示欣賞
admire yourself	欣賞自己的外貌；視語氣可帶自我陶醉意味
admiration	對某人 / 某物產生的高度欣賞、敬意或讚賞
admirable	因品格、行為或表現良好而值得別人敬佩 / 欣賞的
admirably	以令人尊重、欣賞或認為出色的方式
admiring	表現出欣賞、敬佩或讚美態度的
much-admired	實際受到很多人高度敬佩 / 欣賞的

For your original passage

> “I also **admire the way she has handled hardship in life without becoming bitter**.”

The exact meaning is:

admire = respect and appreciate someone because of their character and behaviour

Therefore:

> **admire the way she has handled hardship**

= **「敬佩她面對 / 處理人生困境的方式」**

The reason for the admiration is very specific:

> she has experienced hardship

but:

> she has not become bitter.

So you are not merely saying:

> “I like what she did.”

You are saying:

> **her way of responding to hardship reveals a quality of character that I deeply respect.**

That makes **admire** stronger and more precise than **like**.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **I admire my grandmother.**

> = 我敬佩外婆。

> **I admire her patience.**

> = 我欣賞 / 敬佩她的耐性。

> **I admire her for staying kind.**

> = 我敬佩她即使如此仍保持善良。

> **I admire the way she handles problems.**

> = 我敬佩她處理問題的方式。

> **admire the view**

> = 欣賞風景

> **admire a painting**

> = 欣賞畫作

> **admiration for her courage**

> = 對她勇氣的敬佩

> ****an admirable quality****

> = 值得敬佩的特質

> ****handle something admirably****

> = 把事情處理得很出色 / 令人敬佩

> ****an admiring look****

> = 欣賞 / 敬佩的目光

And the most important family distinction is:

> ****admiring****

> = 表示自己在欣賞 / 敬佩別人的

versus:

> ****admirable****

> = 本身值得別人欣賞 / 敬佩的

So ****admire**** is not simply:

> ****admire = 喜歡****

and in your original passage it specifically means:

****“to deeply respect and appreciate her character, especially the way she has endured hardship without becoming bitter.”****